The Chin are a Tibeto-Burmese people who reside in the vast mountain chain running up western Myanmar into northeast India. The Chin state borders India and Bangladesh to the west. The Chin lived predominately in the highlands and mostly were involved in labor-intense agriculture. The lack of infrastructure, including the poor quality of roads and communications, along with the poor quality of the land, leaves the population vulnerable at times.

The Chin population is fragmented with over 40 subgroups living in the region. The Myanmar government neglects the Chins. Educational levels are low and economic development in the region is abysmal. The Chin are weary of encroachment from the Myanmar state.

The Chin are noted for their traditional clothing, including intricately woven blankets with elaborate designs. The Chin are also noted for their fascinating tattoos that sometimes cover nearly their entire face. Many Chins converted to Christianity during the British colonial period, and several fought with the British during the World War II.

Kachin

The Kachin are located in northern Myanmar bordering both China and India. The climate in the region inhabited by the Kachin is extreme, with cold winters and oppressively hot summers. By most accounts the most fiercely independent of all ethnic groups in Myanmar, the Kachin's political identity is solid. A well-defined clan system helps to keep the Kachin organized.

The Kachin strongly opposed British colonial efforts, but many were eventually converted to Christianity by the early-20th century. As with the Karen, the Kachin formed a large part of the British colonial army during World War II. The utter devastation of the war led to a strong nationalist movement emerging among the Kachin. During the negotiations for the creation of the 1947 constitution, the Kachin state was recognized with a promise of the right of secession in 10 years. The state boundaries formulated in 1947 fragmented the Kachin population, with a sizable minority placed in the Shan state. Kachin uprisings against the government have been frequent. During 1950 and again in the early 1960s, armed insurrection occurred. In some cases, the upheaval was based on nationalist